Field Study Report: Gaziantep Metropolitan Municipality Website

Site	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
Organisation	Gaziantep Büyükşehir Belediyesi (Gaziantep Metropolitan Municipality)
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Course	SFWE475 Advanced Web Programming, Assignment 2 (Core tier)
Audit date	7-8 November 2026
Browser	Google Chrome 156.0.8078.80 (64-bit), Windows 11 (Lighthouse run in Mobile mode)

Part A: Under the hood

A1. HTTPS and redirects. When I typed the address with `http://`, the server answered with a 301 Moved Permanently status and sent my browser to `https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/`, which then loaded normally with status 200. The padlock shows a secure connection and a valid certificate. It was issued by Sectigo to `*.gaziantep.bel.tr` (a wildcard certificate that covers all subdomains), is valid from 19 February 2026 and expires on 20 February 2027. This means visitors who use an old `http://` link still end up on the secure version of the site, and the certificate is currently in good order. The expiry date is about three and a half months away, so the municipality should make sure it is renewed on time. [A1]

A2. URL structure. I scored five pages against the five URL rules from Week 5.

#	URL	HTTPS	Short and readable	Lowercase	Hyphens	Few parameters	Overall
1	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/ (home page)	Pass	Pass	Pass	N/A (no words)	Pass (0)	Pass
2	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/basin/duyurular	Pass	Pass	Pass	N/A (single words)	Pass (0)	Pass
3	https://gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/projeler	Pass	Pass	Pass	N/A	Pass (0)	Pass
4	https://gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/projeler/abdulhamit-han-koprulu-kavsagiyla-trafikte-yeni-donem	Pass	Partial (slug is long)	Pass	Pass (`-`, no `_`)	Pass (0)	Partial
5	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/basin/etkinlikler?name=tiyatro	Pass	Pass	Pass	N/A	Pass (1: `name`)	Pass

Pass: the URL meets the rule. Partial: it mostly meets the rule but could be improved. N/A: the rule does not apply.

All five addresses use HTTPS, are written in lowercase, and have no or very few query parameters. The project detail page is the most readable address: its slug uses hyphens and describes the page title, and Turkish letters appear as plain letters (for example "koprulu"), so the address has no unreadable codes. The only parameter I found was `?name=tiyatro` on the events filter, which is short and easy to understand. The one weak point is the long project slug, which is readable but about 50 characters. I also noticed that some pages open on `www.gaziantep.bel.tr` and others on `gaziantep.bel.tr`, so the site seems to use two forms of its main address. I check which one it prefers in A7. [A2]

A3. One request, closely. I reopened the home page with the Network panel open and the cache disabled, which simulated a first-time visit. The first request was for the HTML document. It used the GET method and returned status 200, with the content type text/html; charset=UTF-8. The HTML file itself was small (about 76 kB), yet the page as a whole made 52 requests and transferred 12.9 MB of data (14.5 MB in total resources). The DOMContentLoaded event fired at 2.87 seconds, and the full page finished loading at 6.35 seconds. The only Fetch/XHR requests were POST requests to Google Analytics. They returned status 204 (No Content), so they carried no page content. Overall, the page is quite heavy. The three largest files were two video segments (gaziantep.webm, 4.2 MB and 2.4 MB) and one GIF (chatbot2.gif, 2.3 MB), which is used for the live chat icon. Together they total about 8.9 MB, nearly two-thirds of all transferred data. This can slow the website down, especially on mobile devices with slow connections. I examine this further in B1. [A3]

A4. A page that does not exist. I opened a made-up page address: `/no-such-page-123`. The server returned status 404 (Not Found), which is correct because the page does not exist. The visitor sees a simple error page with the municipality logo and the title “Page Not Found!”, along with a short message explaining that the page may have been removed or moved. The page offers useful navigation options, such as “Go to homepage” and “Go back” buttons. It also includes Quick Links, contact cards, and a bottom navigation bar. However, there is one problem: the error message is only in English. I tried switching the language to

Turkish using the bottom menu, but the page stayed in English. This may confuse Turkish-speaking visitors, since this is a Turkish municipality website. [A4]

A5. Caching. The main page uses `Cache-Control: private, must-revalidate`. This means the browser may store the page on the user's device, but it must check with the server whether the stored copy is still up to date before using it. For the image `a314e3fd-...original.JPG`, which is served from a different domain (`dosya.gaziantep.bel.tr`), the server response contained no Cache-Control header. The no-cache line I saw in the request headers was added by my browser because I had disabled the cache. The server did send ETag and Last-Modified headers, which allow the browser to check whether the image has changed. However, there is no explicit rule about how long the browser may keep the image. Since this is a large image that probably does not change often, setting a longer cache lifetime (for example, with `Cache-Control: public, max-age=...`) would help. Visitors would not need to download the same image again on later visits. [A5]

A6. Where the page is built. I opened the page source with Ctrl+U and searched for text that appears on the website. The menu word "haberler" and the news title "GAZİANTEP BÜYÜKŞEHİR'DEN ULAŞIM HİZMETLERİNDE YENİ DİJİTAL HAMLE" were already present in the HTML source. I also checked the Elements panel and found the same text there (4 matches for the news title). This means the server sends the main content as ready-made HTML, so I conclude that the home page uses server-side rendering. The page still loads many JavaScript files, probably for features such as the news sliders, but the main text is already present without JavaScript. This is beneficial for users on slow connections, and also for search engines, which can read the important content without having to run JavaScript. [A6]

A7. SEO basics. I checked the home page for basic SEO elements. The page has a clear title ("Gaziantep Büyükşehir Belediyesi") and a meta description that explains the purpose of the website. It also has a canonical link pointing to `https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/`. The page language is set to Turkish (`lang="tr"`), and there is only one h1 heading. I could not find any `rel="sponsored"` or `rel="ugc"` links. This is expected, since the website does not appear to have advertisements or user comments. Overall, the basic SEO elements are present, and I did not find any major SEO problems on the home page. The canonical link also shows that the website prefers the www address. This is consistent with my finding in A2, where some pages opened without www. [A7]

Part B: The experience

B1. Loading state. I reloaded the home page with the cache disabled and selected Chrome's slowest network throttling preset ("3G"; in the current Chrome version this is the lowest preset available, and the older "Slow 3G" label is no longer shown). For about 13 seconds, I saw only a loading screen with the municipality logo and three animated dots. The page was not completely blank, but nothing was usable during this time. After that, the text and page layout appeared, but the images loaded much more slowly. After one minute, only about 3.3 MB had been downloaded, and many news images were still loading. One image was only partially visible, and no placeholder was shown while it loaded. The small icons appeared as empty boxes, probably because the icon font had not loaded yet. The background video was also not visible. This can be a problem for visitors with slow connections. They have to wait a long time, and even after the page appears, some parts are still missing. [B1]

B2. Empty state. On the events page, I typed "zzzqqq" into the search box and clicked the search button. The page did not show an error or a blank area. Instead, it displayed an icon and the message "Kayıt bulunamadı" ("No records found"), along with a "Tüm Etkinlikler" ("All Events") button. The filter section showed "Toplam: 0 kayıt" ("Total: 0 records") and a "Temizle" ("Clear") button. The text I typed stayed in the search box, so visitors can easily correct their search if they made a mistake. I think this is a clear and friendly empty state because it offers the visitor another option. However, it could be improved if the message also suggested checking the spelling or trying a different search term. Also, "Sayfa: 1 / 1" ("Page: 1 / 1") looks slightly odd when there are no results. Finally, this message is in Turkish, whereas the 404 page I checked in A4 was in English, which shows an inconsistency in language handling across the site. [B2]

B3. Error state. I set the network to Offline in DevTools (with the cache disabled) and then opened another page of the site, `/tr/basin/duyurular?name=tapu`. The visitor did not see any message from the website. Instead, Chrome showed its own error page (`ERR_INTERNET_DISCONNECTED`) with the offline dinosaur game ("Press space to play"). The page also offers a "Reload" button. This is expected when a new page cannot

be loaded at all, because the website's own code cannot run without a connection. Therefore, I cannot say that the site handles this situation badly. I did not check whether the site offers an offline page. Afterwards, I set the network back to online. [B3]

B4. Form validation. I opened the "Tesis Ziyaret Formu" ("Facility Visit Form"). Before clicking submit, I could not tell which fields were required, because there were no asterisks, red marks, or "required" labels. I typed only one letter in the first field ("Ziyarette Bulunacak Kurum / Kişi") and left the "Adı" field empty. When I clicked submit, a small message appeared next to the empty field saying "Please fill out this field." This message is in English and appears to come from Chrome's built-in validation system rather than from the website itself. Turkish visitors may see it in Turkish, depending on their browser's language settings. Showing the error next to the empty field is a good practice, and the text I had entered in the first field was not deleted. However, visitors cannot see which fields are required before submitting the form. The message also highlights only one missing field at a time and does not explain what the visitor needs to enter. [B4]

B5. Labels. On the "Tesis Ziyaret Formu", every field has a visible label above it, such as "Adı", "Soyadı", "E-Posta" and "Telefon". The phone field also shows an example format as a placeholder, which is helpful. However, when I clicked on the label "Adı", nothing happened: the cursor did not move into the input field. The field became active only when I clicked inside the input box itself. The other fields I tested behaved the same way. I checked the Elements panel and found the reason. The `label` for "Adı" has no `for` attribute, and the `input` has no `id`, so the two are not connected in the page code. The input does have a `required` attribute, which relates to my finding in B4: the field is required, but the website does not show this to visitors. This makes the labels less useful for mouse users, who cannot click a label to focus its field. It can also cause problems for screen reader users, because the field's accessible name may not be announced correctly. [B5]

B6. Keyboard only. My task was to find the organisation chart ("Teşkilat Şeması") using only the Tab, Shift+Tab and Enter keys. The focus outline was easy to see and follow, and the link order was logical, moving from left to right. However, when I pressed Tab for the first time, I could not find a "skip to content" link. As I continued pressing Tab, the focus entered the news slider and got stuck there. Even after about 25 presses, I could not leave the slider with Tab. I had to press Shift+Tab to go backwards, and then use Enter on a link to open the page. This behaves like a keyboard trap. It can be a serious problem for visitors who cannot use a mouse, such as people with motor disabilities, and for screen reader users. They may get stuck in the slider and be unable to reach the rest of the page. Adding a "skip to content" link would also help keyboard users bypass the menu and the slider more easily. [B6]

B7. Automated audit. I used Lighthouse to check the accessibility of the home page and the events page in Mobile mode. The home page scored 68/100 and the events page scored 67/100. Both scores show that the pages need improvement.

- **Home page, main problems:** buttons without accessible names; images without alt text; form fields without labels; links without discernible names.
- **Events page, main problems:** form fields without labels; `user-scalable="no"` in the viewport settings, which can prevent users from zooming on their phones; no main landmark on the page; some text with insufficient contrast against its background.

The missing form labels on both pages are consistent with what I found in my manual test in B5. The missing main landmark is also related to my keyboard test in B6, where I could not find a "skip to content" link. I only tested in Mobile mode, so the scores may be different on desktop. Lighthouse also cannot detect every problem. For example, it did not detect the keyboard trap in the news slider, which is why I also did manual tests. [B7]

B8. Link and button text. Lighthouse found 10 buttons without accessible names on the home page. I checked them and found that they are the round eye-icon buttons at the bottom right of each card in the "Duyurular" ("Announcements") slider. In the page code, these buttons contain only an icon, with no text or label. This means screen reader users may hear only the word "button" and will not know what it does. The arrow buttons in the slider do have names, but they are in English ("Previous slide" and "Next slide"). Since the website is in Turkish, Turkish names would be more appropriate. I also checked the chat robot button at the bottom right of the page. It uses only a background image (the same `chatbot2.gif` I found in A3), and I could not find any text or label for it. The table shows the elements I checked and my suggested names. [B8]

#	Element and location	Current text	Better text
1	Home page, bottom right of each announcement card (10 buttons)	None (eye icon only)	"Duyuruyu oku" ("Read the announcement")
2	Announcements slider, left arrow	"Previous slide"	"Önceki duyuru" ("Previous announcement")
3	Announcements slider, right arrow	"Next slide"	"Sonraki duyuru" ("Next announcement")
4	Chat robot button, fixed at the bottom right	None (background image only)	"Canlı sohbeti aç" ("Open live chat")

Part C: Recommendations

What works well

1. The website redirects old `http://` links to `https://` with a 301 status. It also has a valid certificate, so visitors use the secure version of the website [A1].
2. The empty search result is clear and friendly. When I searched for “zzzqqq”, the page showed a message and a “Tüm Etkinlikler” (“All Events”) button, and my search text stayed in the box, so I could correct it easily [B2].

Three problems to fix first

I ranked the keyboard trap first because it stops some visitors completely, the heavy home page second because it slows down almost everyone on a weak connection, and the unnamed buttons and form fields third because they are the easiest to fix.

1. The news slider traps keyboard users.

- **Problem:** When I used the Tab key, the focus got stuck inside the news slider and I could not move on to the rest of the page.
- **Evidence:** [B6], [B7].
- **Who it affects:** People who cannot use a mouse, including people with motor disabilities and screen reader users.
- **Fix:** Make it possible to move past the slider with the Tab key, and add a “skip to content” link at the top of the page.
- **Effort:** Medium. **Impact:** High.

2. The home page is too heavy.

- **Problem:** The home page is very heavy (52 requests and about 12.9 MB, almost two-thirds of it two videos and one GIF), so on a slow connection I waited about 13 seconds for a usable page and many images were still loading.
- **Evidence:** [A3], [B1], [A5].
- **Who it affects:** Visitors using mobile data or slow internet connections.
- **Fix:** Compress the large GIF and videos, do not load the background video on mobile phones, load images only when they are needed (lazy loading), and increase the cache time for images.
- **Effort:** Medium. **Impact:** High.

3. Buttons and form fields have no names or labels.

- **Problem:** The eye-icon and chat buttons have no names, the form labels are not connected to their fields, and required fields are not marked before the visitor presses submit.
- **Evidence:** [B4], [B5], [B7], [B8].
- **Who it affects:** Screen reader users and people who use the forms.
- **Fix:** Add a clear name to every icon button, connect each label to its input field, and mark required fields with a star (*) and a short note.
- **Effort:** Low. **Impact:** Medium.

Other finding. The 404 page and its language menu stay in English even though this is a Turkish website [A4]. This is different from other parts of the website, where messages are shown in Turkish [B2].

Appendix A: Evidence log

One row per piece of evidence. Files are in the `evidence/` folder of the repository. Times are from my computer clock (dd.mm.yyyy).

ID	File	What it shows	Time and date	Page address
A1	evidence/A1-redirect.png	http:// request answered with 301 redirect to https://	07.11.2026 16:49	http://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
A1	evidence/A1-padlock.png	Padlock: connection secure, certificate valid	07.11.2026 16:59	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
A1	evidence/A1-certificate.png	Certificate issuer and validity dates	07.11.2026 16:59	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
A2	evidence/A2-url1.png	Home page address	07.11.2026 17:22	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
A2	evidence/A2-url2.png	Announcements page address	07.11.2026 17:23	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/basin/duyurular
A2	evidence/A2-url3.png	Projects list address (no www)	07.11.2026 17:23	https://gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/projeler
A2	evidence/A2-url4.png	Project detail address with long slug	07.11.2026 17:24	https://gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/projeler/abdulhamit-han-koprulu-kavsagiyla-trafikte-yeni-donem
A2	evidence/A2-url5.png	Events page with one query parameter	07.11.2026 17:25	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/basin/etkinlikler?name=tiyatro
A3	evidence/A3-headers.png	Headers panel of the first (document) request	07.11.2026 20:15	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
A3	evidence/A3-summary.png	Network summary bar: number of requests and total size (cache disabled)	07.11.2026 20:22	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
A3	evidence/A3-xhr.png	One Fetch/XHR request and its headers	07.11.2026 21:14	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
A3	evidence/A3-largest.png	Network list sorted by size: largest files are a video and a GIF	07.11.2026 21:36	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
A4	evidence/A4-missingpage.png	404 page: friendly message, homepage button; Network shows status 404	07.11.2026 21:40	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/no-such-page-123
A4	evidence/A4-language.png	404 page still in English after choosing Turkish in the language menu	07.11.2026 21:46	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/no-such-page-123
A5	evidence/A5-cache.png	Response headers of the main document: Cache-Control private, must-revalidate	07.11.2026 22:03	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
A5	evidence/A5-cache-image.png	Response headers of one image: no Cache-Control, ETag and Last-Modified present	07.11.2026 22:05	https://dosya.gaziantep.bel.tr/uploads/new/2026/10/a314e3fd-de6a-4278-9f8e-640659023ed0_original.JPG
A6	evidence/A6-source.png	Raw page source (Ctrl+U): menu word "haberler" found	07.11.2026 23:10	view-source:https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
A6	evidence/A6-elements.png	Elements panel: same menu word found	07.11.2026 23:11	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
A6	evidence/A6-source-news.png	Raw page source: a news headline from the slider is found	07.11.2026 23:13	view-source:https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
A6	evidence/A6-elements-news.png	Elements panel: same headline found	07.11.2026 23:14	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
A7	evidence/A7-seo.png	Console checks: title, meta description, canonical, lang, h1 count, sponsored/ugc count	08.11.2026 01:18	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
B1	evidence/B1-loading-1.png	Loading screen (logo and three dots), about 11 s after reload with the 3G preset	08.11.2026 01:27	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
B1	evidence/B1-loading-2.png	Page content visible, icons shown as empty boxes, about 30 s after reload	08.11.2026 01:27	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
B1	evidence/B1-loading-3.png	News photo only partly drawn, many images still pending, about 1 min after reload	08.11.2026 01:28	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
B2	evidence/B2-empty.png	Events filter with "zzzqqq": message "Kayıt bulunamadı", "Tüm Etkinlikler" button, total 0 records	08.11.2026 14:45	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/basin/etkinlikler?name=zzzqqq
B3	evidence/B3-offline.png	Chrome's own offline error page shown when opening another page of the site while Offline (cache disabled)	08.11.2026 16:55	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/basin/duyurular?name=tapu
B4	evidence/B4-form-errors.png	Visit form submitted with "Adı" empty: browser bubble "Please fill out this field." under the field; no required marks before submit	08.11.2026	https://gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/tesis-ziyaret-formu
B5	evidence/B5-labels.png	Clicking the label text "Adı" does not move focus into the field	08.11.2026	https://gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/tesis-ziyaret-formu
B5	evidence/B5-label-code.png	Elements panel: label has no for attribute; input has no id but has required	08.11.2026	https://gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/tesis-ziyaret-formu

ID	File	What it shows	Time and date	Page address
B6	evidence/B6-focus-visible.png	Keyboard-only: focus outline clearly visible on a menu link	08.11.2026	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
B6	evidence/B6-first-tab.png	First Tab press: no "skip to content" link appears	08.11.2026	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
B6	evidence/B6-trap-1.png	Focus inside the news slider (keyboard trap), first moment	08.11.2026	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
B6	evidence/B6-trap-2.png	Focus still inside the news slider after more Tab presses	08.11.2026	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
B6	evidence/B6-result.png	Organisation chart page reached with Shift+Tab then Enter	08.11.2026	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/teskilat-semasi
B6	evidence/B6-keyboard-log.txt	Short log: task, keys, problems	08.11.2026	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
B7	evidence/B7-lighthouse-home.png	Lighthouse Accessibility report for the home page: score 68, issues listed	08.11.2026 22:45	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
B7	evidence/B7-lighthouse-inner.png	Lighthouse Accessibility report for the events page: score 67, issues listed	08.11.2026 22:58	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/tr/basin/etkinlikler?name=tiyatro
B8	evidence/B8-lighthouse-buttons.png	Lighthouse lists 10 buttons without an accessible name (same class "btn-circle")	08.11.2026 22:45	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
B8	evidence/B8-eye-button-code.png	Elements: announcement card button contains only an eye icon, no text or aria-label	08.11.2026	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
B8	evidence/B8-arrows-code.png	Elements: slider arrow buttons have aria-label "Previous slide" / "Next slide" in English	08.11.2026	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/
B8	evidence/B8-chatbot-code.png	Elements: chat robot button uses a background image (chatbot2.gif), no visible text or aria-label	08.11.2026	https://www.gaziantep.bel.tr/